



Plants for beside hedges, walls, and fences

Areas shaded by vertical structures or hedges do not make natural homes for many plants, but a few tolerate the dark and drought.

Apart from plants that can naturally survive in such areas, you can increase your choices by offering some additional moisture, either by improving the structure of the soil with annual applications of well-rotted compost or by installing an irrigation system to increase soil water levels. Deep shade is also a limitation, although barrenwort, deadnettle, and some ferns will cope. To cover a wall or fence, consider a shrub, such as flowering quince, and others that will climb when confronted with a vertical surface.



PERENNIAL LARGE

Acanthus mollis

COMMON BEAR'S BREECHES This upright semievergreen perennial has long, deeply cut, bright green basal leaves. Tall spikes of funnel-shaped white flowers nestle between dusky purple bracts in summer. Tolerates dry soil and partial shade.

↑ 4ft (1.2m) ↔ 24in (60cm)

☪ Z7–11



PERENNIAL LARGE

Aconitum carmichaelii

MONKSHOOD An upright perennial with deeply divided midgreen leaves and tall spikes of hooded lavender-blue flowers in fall. Use it to inject late-season color at the back of a bed or along a boundary. 'Arendsii' (above) has rich blue flowers.

↑ 5ft (1.5m) ↔ 12in (30cm)

☪ ! Z3–8



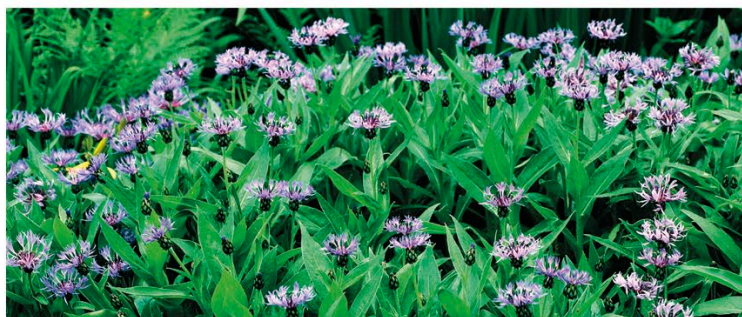
PERENNIAL SMALL

Arum italicum

ITALIAN ARUM A low-growing perennial with arrow-shaped green leaves, which may disappear in extreme cold or heat; a second flush may occur in spring. Considered invasive in some areas. 'Marmoratum' (above) has attractively veined leaves.

↑ 10in (25cm) ↔ 12in (30cm)

☪ ! Z5–9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Centaurea montana

PERENNIAL CORNFLOWER This perennial has oval, tapering green leaves that are hairy beneath. In early summer, it bears thistlelike flowers in shades of purple, blue, white, or pink. A cottage garden favorite, leave it to spread beside a wall or hedge.

↑ 20in (50cm) ↔ 24in (60cm)

☪ Z3–8



SHRUB MEDIUM

Chaenomeles x superba

FLOWERING QUINCE A deciduous shrub with spiny branches and narrow, oval, glossy green leaves. In late spring, it bears clusters of cup-shaped flowers in shades of white, pink, orange, or red, depending on the variety. Train it on a wall or fence.

↑ 5ft (1.5m) ↔ 6ft (2m)

☪ Z5–9



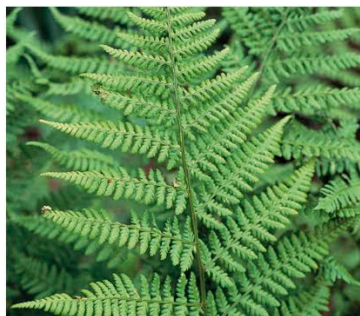
SHRUB LARGE

Crinodendron hookerianum

LANTERN TREE An architectural evergreen shrub with stiff branches and narrow, lance-shaped dark green leaves. From late spring to early summer, lanternlike red flowers appear. Train against a sheltered wall. Best in West Coast gardens.

↑ 20ft (6m) ↔ 15ft (5m)

☪ 卐 Z9–11



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Dryopteris dilatata

BROAD BUCKLER FERN This deciduous or semievergreen fern forms a rosette of arching fronds with triangular to oval serrated segments and dark brown stems. It tolerates the dry soil next to hedges, if watered well in the first season.

↑ 3ft (1m) ↔ 18in (45cm)

☪ Z5–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Epimedium perralderianum

BARRENWORT A semievergreen perennial with large, toothed, glossy, heart-shaped dark green leaves. Airy spikes of small, bright yellow pendent flowers form on wiry stalks in spring before new foliage appears. An effective ground cover in deep shade.

↑ 12in (30cm) ↔ 18in (45cm)

☪ Z5–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Lamium galeobdolon

YELLOW ARCHANGEL A vigorous, mat-forming evergreen perennial with creeping stems of oval, silver-marked dark green leaves and spikes of brown-spotted yellow summer flowers. 'Hermann's Pride' (above) is a less aggressive spreader in gardens.

↑ 24in (60cm) ↔ indefinite

☪ Z4–8